They are set up by the chief minister according to the exigencies of the time and requirements of the situation. Hence, their number, nomenclature and composition varies from time to time.

They not only sort out issues and formulate proposals for the consideration of the cabinet but also take decisions. However, the cabinet can review their decisions.

Table 32.1 Articles Related to the State Council of Ministers at a Glance

Article No.	Subject-matter
163.	Council of Ministers to aid and advise Governor
164.	Other provisions as to Ministers
166.	Conduct of business of the Government of a State
167.	Duties of Chief Minister as respects the furnishing of information to Governor, etc.
177.	Rights of Ministers as respects the Houses

[1]*Shamsher Singh* vs. *State of Punjab* (1974).

[1a]They may, in addition, be in charge of the welfare of the SCs and BCs or any other work.

[2]Each minister need not resign separately; the resignation of the chief minister amounts to the resignation of the entire council of ministers.

[3]The term 'ministry' or 'ministries' is used only in the centre and not in the states. In other words, the state government is divided into departments and not ministries.